Ford Motor Company

James P. Vondale, Director
Automotive Safety Office
Environmental & Safety Engineering

June 15, 2001

Mr. Kenneth N. Weinstein
Associate Administrator for Safety Assurance
National Highway Traffic Safety Administration
400 Seventh Street, S.W.
Washington, D.C. 20590

Dear Mr. Weinstein:

Re: Ford Recall No. 01S20 – 2000-2001 Model Year Windstar Adjustable Accelerator Pedal/Floor Mat Interference

Summary

- Ford Action – Ford is conducting a voluntary safety recall to replace front floor mats on 2000-2001 model year Ford Windstar vehicles equipped with the adjustable pedal option and built at the Oakville Assembly Plant from February 8, 2000 through December 4, 2000.

- Number of Vehicles Involved – Approximately 53,100 vehicles (approximately 45,800 in the U.S., 4,700 in Canada, and 2,600 in Mexico).

- Effect on Vehicle Operation – Ford is aware of a single customer report of the driver floor mat interfering with accelerator pedal, resulting in a stuck throttle. The report did not allege that an accident or injury had occurred. The condition can potentially occur when the pedals are adjusted approximately 80% rearward in their range of travel.

- Service Procedure – Dealers will replace the driver floor mat with one of revised design. To minimize customer dissatisfaction, a matching front passenger floor mat will also be provided.

Attached is the detailed information required by the applicable portions of 49 CFR Part 573 – Defect and Non-Compliance Information Report.

Sincerely,

James P. Vondale

Attachment
01S20 5d/rjw/ae

ATTACHMENT

49 CFR Part 573 – DEFECT INFORMATION REPORT
01S20 – 2000-2001 MODEL YEAR WINDSTAR
ADJUSTABLE ACCELERATOR PEDAL/FLOOR MAT INTERFERENCE

Pursuant to Part 573 of Title 49 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Defect and Noncompliance Reports, Ford Motor Company submits the following information concerning a safety recall action that it is voluntarily initiating.

573.5 (c) (2) – Potentially Affected Vehicles

Certain 2000-2001 model year Ford Windstar vehicles built at the Oakville Assembly Plant from February 8, 2000 through December 4, 2000 and equipped with optional adjustable pedals are potentially affected.

Because these vehicles are not produced in VIN order, information as to the applicability of this action to specific vehicles can best be obtained by either calling Ford's toll-free line (1-800-392-3673) or contacting a local Ford dealer, who can obtain specific information regarding the vehicles from the Ford On-line Automotive Service Information System (OASIS) database.

573.5 (c) (3) – Estimated Population of Vehicles Potentially Affected

Approximately 45,800 vehicles.

573.5 (c) (4) – Estimated Percentage of Affected Vehicles with the Defect Condition

All of the vehicles are potentially susceptible to the condition, but the likelihood of actually exhibiting the condition is dependent on the adjustment of the pedals.

573.5 (c) (5) – Description of the Defect

The driver floor mat may interfere with the accelerator pedal, potentially resulting in a stuck throttle. This condition may occur if the pedals are adjusted in an approximately 2 mm wide area approximately 80% rearward in the range of travel of the pedal adjustment.

Ford is not aware of any reports that allege that a fire, accident, injury, or fatality occurred.

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573.5 (c) (6) -- Chronology of Events

Ford first began investigating this issue during November 2000 based on a single customer report. Although no additional customer reports have been received, investigation has continued and has confirmed the potential for the condition to occur in a narrow band of the pedal adjustment range. Vehicle evaluations conducted during April 2001 revealed that the pedal could become firmly stuck in a position near wide-open throttle. Although there is no evidence of a defect trend, Ford has decided to conduct this action at this time as a precaution.

573.5 (c) (8) -- Service Program

Ford is notifying owners of record of affected vehicles to return them to dealers for installation of a revised driver floor mat. To maintain customer satisfaction, a matching front passenger floor mat will also be installed. This service will be performed at no charge to owners. Ford currently anticipates that owner notification will occur on or before the week of July 9, 2001.

573.5 (c) (9) -- Press Statement and Dealer/Owner Letters

Ford does not plan to make a public statement concerning this action. Notices to dealers and owners from Ford Customer Service Division will be forwarded when available.

573.5 (c) (11) -- Recall Number

Ford has assigned recall number 01S20 to this action.